

Ajai Chowdhry, chairman and CEO, HCL Infosystems, said, "We have taken 25 acres of land in Greater Noida, and the plan is to consolidate our properties which are currently scattered across various units. Also, it will house our software business." The new unit, as per the company, will provide a seating capacity of about 5000 people.

Hughes opens satellite hub at Hyderabad

Hughes Communications has set up its third India satellite hub at Hyderabad. The company plans to invest Rs 250 million in this hub over the next three years. The hub will cater to the growing demand for satellite broadband connectivity and high-bandwidth application services for Indian enterprises and SMBs. It will also serve as a disaster-recovery back-up site for several Indian customers of Hughes besides its own existing hub in Gurgaon, which currently services 40,000 VSATs on a shared hub.

The new hub, working on DVB-S2 technology with ACM/AIS (compensation technology for rain disruptions), makes Hughes the only satellite communications service provider in India to offer hub and satellite-level redundancy to customers as both its KU hubs will operate on different satellites and in different geographies, the company claims. It is equipped with network operating centre, monitoring tools, fibre-optic termination for backhaul traffic, Internet gateway, and applications for content delivery and interactive onsite learning.

MTNL wants to cut employee count by 30,000

State-owned telecom operator Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Limited (MTNL), which currently has over 45,000 employees, has told the Indian government that it requires a mere 15,000 employees to run its businesses. The telco is seeking permission to reduce its staff strength by two-third. On the other hand, the MTNL employee union says it won't allow any job cuts

SNIPPETS

ZTE wins BSNL contract

Recently, China's Huawei won a plump 3G network equipment contract from Tata Teleservices. Now joining the fray, Shenzhen-based ZTE Corp. has bagged a Rs 3-billion contract from Bharat Sanchar Nigam limited BSNL to supply WiMax systems for its broadband rollout. According to The Economic Times, the Indian government's fears about Chinese telecoms gear posing a national security threat are on the wane.

Aries Waaree to set up solar plant in Gujarat

Aries Waaree Solar has bagged an order for engineering services to set up a 40MW solar PV power plant for Adani Group in Gujarat. The company is a joint venture between Mumbai-based Waaree Group and Aries Spain.

Lenovo to launch video gaming console

Chinese IT company Lenovo will launch a video gaming console this year to compete with Nintendo's Wii, Microsoft's Xbox 360 and Sony's PlayStation 3. The company is eyeing the booming motion-gaming market, and has developed a prototype of the eBox console and set up a new company called Beijing eedoo Technology.

Nikon eyes 'new market' with 'new camera'

"It's time for digital cameras to move with the times and Nikon will be ready to take up its usual leadership position," says Makoto Kimura, president, Nikon. The firm is reportedly working on a new camera model to counter harsh competition from makers of small, high-end cameras. It hopes to create a whole new market with its next big idea.

as "the company had already offered a voluntary retirement scheme (VRS) for employees and a few thousand accepted it."

Bharti Airtel, whose revenues are ten times that of MTNL, is the world's third largest, single-country mobile operator and fifth largest telecom operator in the world but it has only 18,000 employees.

Texas Instruments announces design contest

Texas Instruments Incorporated has announced the *Stellaris Design Contest India 2010*. The contest aims at challenging top embedded engineers across the country to demonstrate their skills and innovation. As part of the contest, the contestants have to use Stellaris microcontrollers from Texas Instruments.

The last date for registration is November 30, 2010. Each entry will be judged equally on technical merit, originality, usefulness, cost-effectiveness and design optimisation by an independent panel of judges. Winners will get gift vouchers worth Rs 10,000.

Selected projects also stand a chance to win the Stellaris tool LM358962 EVM.

Toshiba recalls 41,000 laptops

As many as 41,000 laptops have been recalled by Toshiba worldwide because of a fire risk, the US Consumer Product Safety Commission said. "Consumers should stop using recalled products immediately unless otherwise instructed. It is illegal to resell or attempt to resell a recalled consumer product," the commission said in a notice.

The computers at risk are from Toshiba's T130 Satellite line-up—the T135, T135D and ProT130.

"The notebook computers can overheat at the notebook's plug-in to the AC adaptor, posing a burn hazard to consumers," said the commission.

Toshiba is said to have received 129 reports of the notebook computers overheating and deforming the plastic casing area around the AC adaptor plug, including two reports of minor burn injuries that did not require medical attention and two reports of minor property damage.